Intervention Guide: Word Mix Up

Purpose

Objective: Students will become accurate in building and blending decodable words (e.g., CVC, digraphs, consonant blends, CVCe, vowel teams) by learning how to put together letters to make words. Students will also increase automaticity in reading the words built each lesson.

Skill area/need: Accuracy and automaticity in decoding at the word level.

Preparation

Pre-assessment

- Determine need for intervention based on nonsense words or decodable words earlyReading assessment and CBMreading.
    - Students know all letter sounds but have difficulty blending sounds into words quickly. If students do not know all letter sounds or have low accuracy with decoding CVC words, use the *Word Box Intervention* first.

Progress monitoring

- earlyReading nonsense word fluency or decodable words; CBMreading

Time

- Conduct intervention 3-5 times per week for 15-25 minutes until the student(s) attain appropriate grade-level accuracy/automaticity level in reading decodable words (approximately 6-12 weeks).

Materials

- Dry-erase markers and erasers for each student and teacher
- Small white boards or word sheet template and sheet protectors for each student
- Prepared word list (based on selected letter set for the lesson)
- Prepared sentences/story passage for students/teacher
    - Create sentences before lesson for students or use a story passage with a high number of the lesson's words in the story.

Format

- Flexible grouping: classwide, large group, small group or one-on-one

Lesson Sequence Plan

- Introduce unknown word type each week or every other week (CVC, digraphs, consonant blends, CVCe, Vowel Teams) with 4-10 letters each lesson using the prepared word list materials.
- Recommended sequence for teaching types of words: CVC, digraphs, consonant blends, CVCe, Vowel Teams, other letter combinations (Vowel diphthongs, Controlled Vowels)

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Intervention Procedures

Prepare Materials

1. Identify word type to begin teaching in sequence plan above based on students' pre-assessment information and gather the materials for the lesson, including (1) markers/erasers, (2) small white boards, (3) prepared word list, (4) prepared story passage.
   - Hand out materials to students.

Explain the Activity

2. Explain the activity by providing the basic objective and what the activity includes (this step can be shortened when students become familiar with the activity)
   - *"Today you will practice putting letter sounds together to make words. This is important to learn because you need to know how to blend letter sounds together to read different types of words. For the activity, we will review letters and sounds, go over what type of word we will learn, and then make words by replacing letters from the words we make."*

Review Letters and Word Types

3. Review set of letter names/sounds to students using explicit instruction AND/OR review how to decode specific types of words (digraphs, consonant blends, CVCe, vowel teams).
   - For reviewing letter sounds (if needed): *"We will be using the letters ___, ___, ___, ___, ____, and ____ today to make words. I know the sounds of these letters are: /_/, /_/, /_/, /_/, /_/, and /_/."* (then have students repeat sound for each letter)
   - *"We are going to focus on building a type of words often called _____* (digraphs, consonant blends, long vowel/CVCe words, vowel teams)." After introduction, provide a general explanation for the word type and examples of the word type.
     - For digraphs explain how the two letters go together to make one sound: *"There are some letters that can go together and make one sound. These types of words are called digraphs. Some digraphs we will learning include 'sh', 'th', 'ch'* 'ph' and 'wh' (say each letter and write them together on the board). *Each consonant digraph has two consonants and the second consonant is 'h.' 'Sh' makes the /sh/ sound (what sound?). 'Th' makes the /th/ sound* (what sound?), *'Ch' makes the /ch/ sound* (what sound?), *'wh' makes the /wh/ sound* (what sound?), *'ph' makes the /ph/ sound* (what sound?)*. Good."*
     - For consonant blends explain how two or more consonants can be blended together in a row but each sound may be heard in the blend and blends can happen at the end of words. For lesson, go over type of blends being focused on (l blends, r blend etc).
       - *"Consonant blends are made up of two or three letters whose sounds are blended together. Each letter within the blend is pronounced individually, but quickly, so they blend together. For example, I hear _____ (four) sounds in the word _____ (plan –* say sounds *and write word on board). The blend in this word is 'pl' and we could say it's an 'l blend' because the second letter is 'l'. We could say the sounds more slowly /p/, /l/ or we can say them more quickly together /pl/. Let's try another example."*

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- For CVCe explain how when the letter 'e' is at the end of a CVC word that this generally means the vowel will be long and the 'e' at the end of the word is silent.
  - *"When 'e' is added to a short vowel word, the short vowel becomes long and the final 'e' is silent."* You may also review what short versus long vowel sounds are if students have yet to master the difference.
  - Provide an example based on what long vowel words are being taught for the lesson. For example, *"If I have the word 'hop' and then add an 'e' to the end, the o will now be long and the final 'e' is silent"* (adding e at the end makes a vowel say its name)
- For vowel teams, explain how the two vowels work as a team to make one sound (typically the first letter says its long sound) and then go over the vowel teams that will be used in the lesson and what sound they make together.
  - *"Vowel teams are made up of two vowels. Most of the time when two vowels are together, the first vowel makes its long vowel song and the second vowel is silent. We could say that 'when two vowels go walking the first vowel does the talking, and the second vowel does the walking."*
  - Go over an example word for the vowel team(s) of the lesson. *"Let's look at the word 'eat.' I see that it has two vowels in it next to each other (e and a). The first vowel is 'e' and its long vowel sound is '__'. The vowel 'a' is silent."*
- For other word types, teach using a similar explicit instruction approach.

Model the Activity

4. Model the activity to the students while they watch by saying the first word and hold up (or point to) each letter as you say its sound.
   - *"Watch me, I am going to use some of the letters to make the word _____ which is another example of a* _____ (digraph, consonant blend, CVCe, Vowel team)."
     - For CVC and digraphs say: *"I hear the sounds /__/, /__/ and /__/ so I will put the letter __ first, the letter ___ next, and the letter ___ last. Let's check." With student participating chorally, model each sound again and then blend the sounds together to say the word. "/_/…,/_/…,/_/ - ____"*
     - For consonant blends: *"I hear the sounds /__/, /__/, /__/ and /__/ so I will put the letter __ first, then the letter ___ next, the letter ___, and the letter ___ last. Let's check."* With student participating chorally, model each sound again and then blend the sounds together to say the word. *"/_/…,/_/…,/_/ - ____"* (Check to see if students know what two letters make the blend).
     - For CVCe say: *"I know with CVCe words that there will be a silent 'e' at the end after the sounds we hear. I hear the sounds /__/, /__/ and /__/ so I will put the letter __ first, the letter ___ next, the letter ___, and then the silent 'e' goes last. Let's check."* With student participating chorally, model each sound again and then blend the sounds together to say the word. *"/_/…,/_/…,/_/ - ____."*

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- For Vowel Teams say*: "I know with words that include a vowel team there will be two vowels in the middle that work together to make the vowel sound. The first sound I hear in the word ___ is /_/, so I will put the letter ___ first. The second sound I hear is /_/ so I will put the vowels ___ and __ next. The last sound I hear in ___ is /_/ so I will put the ___ last. Let's check."* Model each sound again and then blend the sounds together to say the word. *"/_/…,/_/…,/_/ - _____."*

5. Then, show the students how to replace one letter in a word to make a new word.
   - *"Now, we are going to mix up letters. I am going to take the ____ from the word and put a ____ in its place. Now I have the word /_/, /_/, /_/ - ____. What word do I have?* (Students respond). *Yes, the new word is ____."*

Provide Guided Practice and Give Feedback

6. Next, practice the activity together by having the students replace one letter from the previous word to make a new word. Make another new word with students if additional modeling is needed, particularly when switching out different positions in the word.
   - Say: *"Can you take away the ___ and put ___ in its place. Now what word do you have?"*
   - Provide specific and immediate feedback throughout the word building activity.
     - Correct response: *"Good, that word is ___."*
     - Incorrect response: *"No, that word is ____. What word is it? Good."*
     - If students make a mistake when replacing the letter, repeat the directions for what letter to replace and follow Step 5 if additional support is needed.
7. Continue to build the rest of the words on the prepared word sequence using the same procedure described in step 6.
   - Provide immediate corrective feedback when needed.
   - If completing the activity in a large group, have each student make the word on his/her marker board but have students take turn saying the words. Make sure students are working quietly and not calling out answers.
   - As the words are built, make a list on your teacher marker board of the words.

Provide Independent and General Practice

8. After completing the word building sequence, check to see if the students can correctly read at least 90% of the words on a prepared word list or using flashcards (have students respond chorally or have each student say all words and take turns).
   - If students are not able to read 90% of words, go back and review the words and the general rule for how to read the specific type of words being taught in the lesson.
9. Provide connected text or create short sentences with the word list sequence for students to read in pairs or chorally as a class and then in pairs (e.g., paragraph with all of the words in it).
   - Read the connected text or sentences to the students first and then have students read the text with you out loud chorally or in pairs.

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Additional Ideas

Procedure modifications or accommodations

- Include letter sounds or types of words that are currently being taught during core instruction as target letter sounds during the intervention.
- Use connected text from core instruction with high proportion of words that were built.
- Before reading the connected text, have each student go through the story and underline the words they learned during the lesson.
- Based on student and ability to remain focused, provide marker boards/letters to all students or use one set as the teacher and have students participate by taking turns.

Additional Practice Ideas

- Have students use a marker and create/write short sentences with the words underlined in each sentence.

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